

Enterprise ABM, built on a \$500K budget

COMPANY	ANNUAL MARKETING BUDGET	ENGAGEMENT
Technology services firm	\$500K	Consulting · full-lifecycle ABM build

01 SITUATION

The starting point

A custom software services firm selling large engagements to enterprise buyers, with roughly \$500K a year to market on. At that budget there is no room for volume plays: every dollar has to land on accounts that can buy, and the executives who sign those deals don't respond to volume campaigns anyway. The engagement: build the account-based marketing engine, end to end.

02 THE BUILD

The engine

- **The ICP, redefined first.** Before any campaign spend, a rebuilt definition of the accounts worth pursuing, so the program targeted a named enterprise account list instead of a broad market.
- **A full-lifecycle ABM program.** Account selection, engagement, and nurture designed as one connected system across the funnel, not a sequence of disconnected campaigns.
- **Executive communications as a channel.** Enterprise deals close on relationships and authority, so the program reached the executive buyer directly instead of relying on email volume.
- **Content strategy rebuilt around the ICP,** so every asset spoke to the named accounts' problems rather than the general market's.
- **Direct mail, launched as a working motion.** A physical channel that cuts through inboxes enterprise executives don't open, aimed at the named account list.

03 WHAT IT CHANGED

What they kept

The firm went from broad-market marketing to a repeatable named-account motion its team could run: a defined ICP and account list, lifecycle stages with content mapped to each, and executive-facing channels (direct mail, executive communications) that fit how their buyers make decisions. The budget didn't grow; the precision did.

04 WHY IT MATTERS

The relevant part

A small budget forces the discipline that big budgets let you skip: define exactly who you sell to, pick the channels their executives respond to, and connect every asset to a named account. That is the same shape as any business with six-figure contracts and a finite list of institutional buyers, where one right account is worth more than a thousand impressions.

Client engagement through my consulting practice; name withheld. References available in conversation.